

Glossary

alpine

Of or relating to high mountain areas.

amphitheater

An oval-shaped, open-air arena, usually where public events take place.

ancestor

An earlier person, animal, or object from the past of someone or something existing today.

annex

To take over territory that belongs to another country.

archipelago

A group of islands.

arid

Describes an area with little or no rainfall.

atoll

A ring-shaped coral reef that surrounds an area of shallow water, such as a lagoon.

bonsai

A Japanese art form of growing miniature trees and shrubs in pots using a special pruning technique.

calligraphy

The art of elegant or decorative handwriting.

casino

A space where gambling games are played.

cease-fire

An agreement to suspend fighting, usually to discuss terms of peace.

chateau

A large castle or stately home in France.

city-state

A city that is self-governing and does not belong to another country or state.

civilization

A group of people who share the same society, culture, and way of life.

climate

The average weather patterns of a particular area over a long period of time.

coastline

An area where land and ocean meet.

colonialism

A system by which one country takes political control of another country, and exploits its resources for financial or economic gain.

colony

An area that is ruled by another country.

communism

A system by which all property and industry is owned by the government. Wealth and resources are evenly distributed among the state's citizens.

constitution

A set of laws that describes the basic rights and duties of all citizens. A constitution also determines how a country should be governed.

currency

Anything that is widely accepted as money in a particular country.

delta

A flat area, sometimes triangular in shape, that forms from the settling of silt and sand at the mouth of a river.

democracy

A system of government in which people choose their leaders through elections.

diverse

Describes a population of people that includes many different races, cultures, societies, and religions.

dynasty

A ruling family whose power passes from one generation to the next.

empire

A group of countries or territories ruled by a single monarch or government.

endangered

A species with a low population that is at risk of becoming extinct.

endemic

A plant or animal species that

is native to a particular area and found nowhere else.

ethnicity

The language, culture, and beliefs of a particular group of people.

exports

The sale of goods and services to other countries.

extinction

When all the members of a species die out.

fado music

A Portuguese style of singing in which the vocalist laments the hardships of daily life.

fjord

A long, thin body of water that extends inland from the sea, often between high cliffs.

folklore

The customs, traditions, and stories of a community passed down through generations, usually by word of mouth.

glacial lake

A lake formed when a glacier erodes the land and then melts, filling in the cavity left behind by the glacier.

Gothic

Describes a style of architecture used in western Europe between the 12th and 16th centuries.

Hangul

The Korean alphabet.

harbor

A place where ships may moor safely, usually due to the presence of piers, jetties, and other human-made structures.

